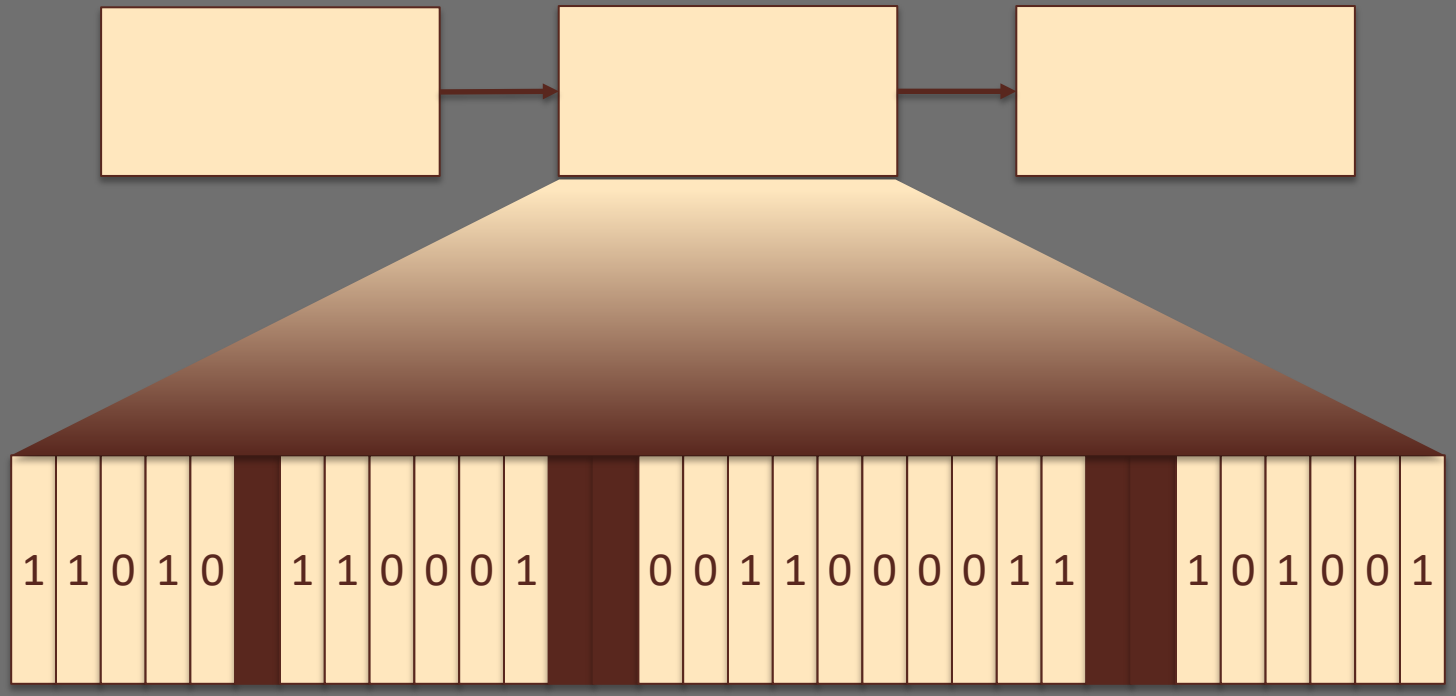
Memory Hierarchy: Fragmentation

Pages of data



Fragmentation



Unused space.

Some causes of fragmentation

Delete

- Deleting data forms “hole”.
- Expensive to fill hole.

Insert into ordered data

- Expensive to move all following data.
- Alternative: Insert new linked chunk.



Costs & benefit of fragmentation

- More disk seeks
- Harder to find unused space.
- Might use space when inserting data.